A-A-53986
15 September 1989

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

RUBBER DAM (DENTAL) 36s

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Federal Specification ZZ-R-690B, dated 20 October 1985, which is cancelled.

Salient characteristics:

This commercial item description covers rubber dams suitable for use in establishing a dry surgical field during dental restoration or endodontic procedures. The dams shall be classified as having medium, heavy, or extra heavy thickness.

The rubber dams shall be of the following thickness for the applicable sizes:

Size	Thickness (inch)
Medium	0.007 to 0.009
Heavy	0.009 to 0.0115
Extra Heavy	0.0115 to 0.0135

Material. The dam shall be fabricated from natural rubber latex.

Style, design and dimensions. The dams shall be blue or green in color so as to contrast with the tooth structures. Each rubber dam shall be pre-cut into a square, 6 ± 1/8 inches on a side. The thickness dimensions shall be: medium, 0.007 to 0.009 inch; heavy 0.009 to 0.0115 inch; and extra heavy 0.0115 to 0.0135 inch, respectively.

Tensile strength. The rubber dam shall have a minimum tensile strength of 4000 pounds per square inch (psi) when tested in accordance with ASTM Designation D412.

Ultimate elongation. The rubber dam shall have a minimum ultimate elongation of 800% when tested in accordance with ASTM Designation D412.

AMSC N/A FSC 6520

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Resistance to accelerated aging. The rubber dam shall have tensile strength and ultimate elongation values which are no less than 50% of the original value when tested after being in an environment of 70 ± 2 (^{0}C) for 166 ± 1 hours in accordance with ASTM Designation D573.

Workmanship. A slight curvature or temporary fusion of the cut edges to one another due to rotary cutting is permitted, provided separation can be accomplished easily by the operator without tearing of edges. Rubber dam shall have a smooth surface finish on both sides. Rubber dam shall be free from unpleasant odor or taste, ingrained particles, blisters, holes, tears and other imperfections which may detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing thirty-six rubber dams, as specified, constitutes one unit. Rubber dams shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size for 36 dams to lie flat, one on top of another. Box closure shall be adequate to prevent spilling of contents under normal handling.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality for raw material, supplied by the manufacturer, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the item identification, the name of the material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

Sampling for examination. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one package of rubber dams. A minimum of three rubber dams from each package in the sample shall be examined for defects. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for examination shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, at inspection level II. Examination for defects shall include but shall not be limited to those listed below:

Defects

Rubber dams have an unpleasant odor or taste.
Surfaces not free from ingrained particles, blisters or other imperfections visible to the unaided eye.
Edges not clean cut.
Color not blue or green.
Pre-cut rubber dams rip, tear, or shred when separated; dams do not separate easily.

Sampling for tests. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one pre-cut rubber dam. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, at inspection level S-1.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with the requirements of this commercial item description.

Dimensions test. The length, width and thickness of each rubber dam to be tested shall be determined by using the average value of three measurements for each dimension. The length and width shall be measured to the nearest 1/8 inch while the dam is placed on a smooth, flat surface, using a graduated scale or tape. The thickness shall be measured to the nearest 0.001 inch after the dam is placed on the anvil of a micrometer, and the presser foot gently lowered until contact is made with the rubber dam surface. The thickness shall then be read from the micrometer dial. A dial indicator with a flat anvil may also be used to conduct this test.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch/pounds units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6520-00-754-2769	RUBBER DAM, Medium, 36s
6520-00-754-2770	RUBBER DAM, Heavy, 36s
6520-01-049-0425	RUBBER DAM, Extra Heavy, 36s

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling and marking must be as specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PROJECT NO. 6520-2298
LOCATION: NCR DISK 2

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO. 4968 WASHINGTON D.C.

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN: DPSC- RSIE
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53986	RUBBER DAM (Dental) 36s

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil - Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.